

Utsoree Das (she/her)

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Applied economist working in cross-cutting areas of environment and resource, development, innovation, and sustainable transformation. Music enthusiast.

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of Geneva Postdoctoral Researcher , Geneva School of Economics and Management – Project under the Swiss National Science Foundation (SNSF)	Geneva, Switzerland July 2026 - Present
Transpath (Horizon Europe Research and Innovation Programme) Economist and Researcher , University of Geneva – Project under the European Union (EU) – Randomised Control Trial for Digitalisation, Traceability, and Deforestation Compliance - Cocoa Supply Chain of Ghana * Field visits: Kumasi, Juaben, Apemso, Agona, Nkawie - Ashanti Region, Ghana (Jan 2025) * Pilot study: 5 selected villages, Nkawie district - Ashanti Region, Ghana (Nov 2025) News article , Post * Field visits: Sankofa Agroforestry cocoa farms, Bibiani - Western North Region, Ghana (Nov 2025) * Training sessions: Kumasi, Ghana (<i>upcoming</i>) (August 2026)	Geneva, Switzerland August 2023 - Present
International Trade Centre (ITC) Consultant Economist, Decarbonisation Framework of ITC	Geneva, Switzerland October 2024 - March 2025
International Labour Organization (ILO) Research Intern, ILO RESEARCH - Work, Income, and Equity Unit	Geneva, Switzerland April 2024 - March 2025
Reserve Bank of India (RBI) Research Intern, Department of Economic & Policy Research; Supervisor: Dr. Raj Rajesh, Director – Project: “Bank Funding to Self Help Groups in India: A Panel Data Analysis”	Kolkata, India April 2020 - July 2020
Bengal Chamber of Commerce and Industries (BCCI) Research Intern; Supervisor: Subhodip Ghosh, Director General; BCCI	Kolkata, India Dec 2019 - Jan 2020

EDUCATION

University of Geneva Ph.D. in Economics – Field: Applied Microeconomics - Environment, Resource, Development, Political Econ, Experiments, Migration – Thesis: “ <i>Essays in Environmental and Development Economics</i> ”, Advisor: Salvatore Di Falco	Geneva, Switzerland 2021–2026
Study Centre Gerzensee - Foundation of the Swiss National Bank Swiss Program for Beginning Doctoral Students in Economics (PhD Qualifiers), GPA: 5.5/6.0 (Fully funded by the Swiss National Bank and University of Geneva) – Sequences: Microeconomics, Macroeconomics, and Econometrics	Gerzensee, Switzerland 2021–2022
Indian Institute of Foreign Trade M.A. Economics (specialisation in Trade & Finance)- First Class, First - Gold Medal; GPA: 8.72/9.00 – Thesis: “Cash Transfers, Labour Supply, Poverty, and Entrepreneurial Incentive”, Advisor: Sugata Marjit	Delhi & Kolkata, India 2019–2021
Presidency University B.Sc. Economics - First Class, First - Gold Medal; GPA: 9.15/10.00 – Thesis: “‘Missing Girls’: Decline in the Child Sex Ratio in India”, Advisor: Zakir Husain	Kolkata, India 2016–2019

PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- “A study of the employment and earnings outcomes of second-generation migrants” (with Sevane Ananian and Giulia Dellaferrera); *ILO Working Papers*, 2025
- “Leaving Home: Cumulative Climate Shocks and Migration in Sub-Saharan Africa” (with Salvatore Di Falco, Anna B. Kis, and Martina Viarengo); *Environmental and Resource Economics*, 2024
- “Adaptive Capacity and Subsequent Droughts: Evidence from Ethiopia” (with Salvatore Di Falco and Avichal Mahajan); *Environment and Development Economics*, 2023

POLICY REPORTS

- “Horizontal inequalities in the labour market: A transnational review of the employment and wage outcomes of vulnerable groups” (with Sevane Ananian, Giulia Dellaferrera, Lena Hassani-Nezhad, and Nick Drydakis); *ILO Research Brief*, 2025
- “Exploring Policy Leverage Points to Trigger Transformative Change in Finance and Trade” (with Francisco Alpízar, Salvatore Di Falco, Paul Dingkuhn, and Jeanne Nel); *Deliverable D4.1- Horizon Europe TRANSPATH Project*, 2023

WORKING PAPERS

- “The Local Advantage: Firm Selection Under Weak Institutions” (with Erik Katovich and Jonah Rexer); *CEPR: STEG Working Paper*, *INFER Working Paper*, *IDEAS repec*, *GOV.UK*
- “Development Assistance and Crime-Accused Politicians: Evidence from Indian Elections” (with Souparna Maji) - *under review*; *SSRN 5797011*

WORKS IN PROGRESS

- “Digital Traceability for Deforestation-Free Supply Chains: Evidence from Cocoa Production in Ghana” (with George Akandinge, Francisco Alpízar, Mensah Cobbinah, Salvatore Di Falco, and Erik Katovich)
- R&R at the *Journal of Development Economics* (Pre-Registered Report)
- RCT In-Progress: [AEA RCT Pre-Registration](#)

CONFERENCES AND INVITED PRESENTATIONS

- [World Congress of Environmental and Resource Economists](#) - Carcavelos, Portugal June - July 2026
- [IEA World Congress](#) - Belgrade, Serbia June 2026
- [Transformative Change for Biodiversity Cluster Conference](#) - Brussels, Belgium June 2026
- [HEC Liège Young Researchers Conference in Economics](#) - Liège, Belgium April 2026
- [TRANSPATH Consortium Annual Meeting](#) - Prague, Czech Republic February 2026
- [Alumni Research Dissemination Workshop](#), Indian Institute of Foreign Trade, India January 2026
- [INFER Annual Conference](#), Sapienza University of Rome, Italy September 2025
- [Annual Congress 2025, Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics](#) - ETH Zurich, Switzerland June 2025
- [TRANSPATH Consortium Annual Meeting](#) - Sofia, Bulgaria March 2025
- [Swiss Joint PhD Seminar in Agricultural Economics: 6th Edition](#) - Geneva, Switzerland January 2025
- [PoNACEE Geneva Workshop](#) - Geneva, Switzerland November 2024
- [Annual Congress 2024, Swiss Society of Economics and Statistics](#) - Lucerne, Switzerland June 2024
- [TRANSPATH Consortium Annual Meeting](#) - World Trade Centre, The Hague, The Netherlands March 2024
- [PhD Day Workshop: Geneva Graduate Institute and University of Geneva](#) - Geneva, Switzerland February 2024
- [IEE - GSEM Brownbag Seminar: University of Geneva](#) - Geneva, Switzerland June 2023; October 2024
- [TRANSPATH Consortium Annual Meeting](#) - Wageningen University, Wageningen, The Netherlands February 2023
- [Swiss Joint PhD Seminar in Agricultural Economics: 4th Edition](#) - Tänikon, Switzerland January 2023

GRANTS AND AWARDS

- [IEE Best Teaching Assistant Award](#) - GSEM, University of Geneva, Switzerland 2025
- [INFER Best PhD Paper Award: 1’000 EUR](#) - International Network for Economic Research (INFER), Rome 2025
- [Subside Tremplin Award: 27’800 CHF](#) - Equality and Diversity Service, University of Geneva, Switzerland 2025
- [SNSF Scientific Exchanges Grant: 10’000 CHF \(P.I., RViE\)](#) - Swiss National Science Foundation, Switzerland 2024
- [Conference Grant: 10’000 CHF \(P.I., RViE\)](#) - [GSEM](#) and [University of Geneva](#), Switzerland 2024
- [I.S.E.O. Scholarship: 1’600 EUR](#) - Institute for Studies on Economics and Employment, Italy 2024
- [Agricultural and Applied Economics Assoc. \(AAEA\) Trust Scholarship: 500 USD](#) - Arizona State University, USA 2023
- [Gold Medal: First Class, First Position](#) in M.A. Economics (2019-2021) - Indian Institute of Foreign Trade 2021
- [Gold Medal: First Class, First Position](#) in B.Sc. Economics (2016-2019) - Presidency University 2019
- [Debasish Chandra Memorial Prize- Presidency University, First position in B.Sc. Economics](#) 2019
- [UN Ghoshal Prize- Presidency University, First position in B.Sc. Economics](#) 2019
- [Gold Medal- IMO Mathematics Olympiad, Science Olympiad foundation \(SOF\)](#) 2013

WORKSHOPS, COURSES, SUMMER SCHOOLS

- [Tech Clinic: Programming in Julia](#) - Marko Mlikota October 2025
Hoffmann Centre for Global Sustainability, The Graduate Institute, Geneva, Switzerland
- [Twenty-Fourth Summer School in International and Development Economics](#) September 2025
*Geo-economics, Natural Resources, and Development - Mathieu Couttenier, Mathias Thoenig
Castello di Gargonza, Tuscany, Italy*
- [Advanced Courses in Economics for Doctoral Students and Faculty Members: The New and Wondrous Econometrics of Causal Inference - Alberto Abadie](#) February 2025
Study Centre Gerzensee- Foundation of the Swiss National Bank , Switzerland
- [Advanced Courses in Economics for Doctoral Students and Faculty Members: Machine Learning for Treatment Effects and Structural Equation Models - Victor Chernozhukov](#) July–August 2024
Study Centre Gerzensee- Foundation of the Swiss National Bank , Switzerland
- [I.S.E.O. Summer School in Economics: The World Economy’s Shifting Winds](#) June 2024
*Joshua Angrist, Robert Engle, Michael Spence, Beata Javorcik
Iseo, Brescia, Italy*
- [Summer School on Development Economics in the Field- Surveys, Measurements, and Experiments](#) June 2023
Paris School of Economics, Paris, France
- [Workshop on Survey Design & Experimental Methods in Applied and Agricultural Economics](#) May 2023
AAEA, Arizona State University, Mesa, USA
- [Advanced Courses in Economics for Doctoral Students and Faculty Members: Ex Ante and Ex Post Policy Evaluation Approaches - Petra Todd](#) May 2023
Study Centre Gerzensee- Foundation of the Swiss National Bank , Switzerland
- [PhD courses: Advanced Development Micro and Macro: Market Failures & Empirical Research](#) 2022 –2023
The Graduate Institute, Geneva, Switzerland
- [PhDs & Faculty: Reading Group in Economics & Econometrics + Experimental Econ mini-course](#) 2022 –2026
GSEM- University of Geneva, Geneva, Switzerland
- [Summer School on Theoretical Physics & Quantum Mechanics](#) May 2015
Indian Association for the Cultivation of Science (IACS)- Kolkata, India

PARTICIPATION AT INTERNATIONAL MEETINGS

• 112th ILO International Labour Conference <i>Palais des Nations, Geneva, Switzerland</i>	June 2024
• UNCTAD 7th BioTrade Congress <i>Palais des Nations, Geneva, Switzerland</i>	March 2024
• Workshop on International Trade and Multilateralism <i>Villars-sur-Ollon, Switzerland</i>	January 2023
• Local Geneva Trade and Development Workshop <i>WTO and Palais des Nations, Geneva, Switzerland</i>	2022 - 2024

OUTREACH AND SERVICE

• Rare Voices in Economics (RViE) - <i>President: Member of the Steering Committee</i> (2023 - 2025) - <i>Communications coordinator: Website and Media Manager</i> (2021 - 2025) - <i>Co-organizer: 3rd Rare Voices in Economics Conference</i> (20'000 CHF budget- funded by UNIGE - GSEM, & SNSF) (2023 - 2024) - <i>Co-moderator of the Roundtable- “Challenges of Rare Voices: From Households to Institutions”</i> (2024)	2021–2025
• Journal Refereeing - Reviewer - <i>European Review of Agricultural Economics</i> - <i>Environment and Development Economics</i> - <i>Migration and Development</i>	2023–Present
• Mentor: IEE PhD Mentoring Program- University of Geneva	2023–2025
• Conference organizer: Swiss PhD Seminar in Agricultural Economics (6th Edition) - Geneva, Switzerland	2024–2025

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

University of Geneva , Geneva School of Economics and Management Research & Teaching Assistant in Economics at the Institute of Economics and Econometrics	Geneva, Switzerland
– Labour Economics (2022)	– Introduction to Macroeconomics (2023, 2024, 2025)
– Development Economics (2024)	– Introduction to Microeconomics (2022)

SKILLS

- **STATA, R Studio, $\text{\LaTeX}$** , Python, Datawrapper, Julia
- Geospatial: **ArcGIS**, GEODA, Google Earth Engine
- Experiments: **NGENE**, NLOGIT
- Trade: **WITS**, **SMART Sim**, OEC, Trade Map, EORA
- **Bloomberg Market Concepts**, Bloomberg Terminal
- Financial Modeling: MS Excel and VBA

LANGUAGES

- **English:** Native or Bilingual
- **Bengali:** Native
- **French:** Basic (A1)
- **Hindi:** Fluent
- **Urdu:** Intermediate (oral only)

PRE-PHD POSITIONS OF RESPONSIBILITY

• IES- IIFT Economics Society- Core working member <i>Editor (ECOLibrium magazine) and Organising Committee (Academic Seminars). Published articles:</i> - <i>“Impact of US Protectionism and Right-Wing Populism on Deglobalisation”</i> - ECOLibrium 3rd Edition - <i>“India’s Economic Slump and the Breakdown of the Industrial Sector”</i> - ECOLibrium 2nd Edition	2019–2021
• OIKOS- Presidency University Economics Society: Core working member and Public Relations Head <i>Organised ‘ARTHATANTRA’- The Economics Summit, 2017, & 2018; PR & Social Media Team Head</i>	2017–2019
• PUYES- Presidency University Young Entrepreneurs’ Society: Member of the Organising Committee <i>Organised ‘Presidency University Young Entrepreneurs’ Drive’- 2016, 2017, & 2018.</i>	2016–2018

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES

- Classically trained (Hindustani) vocalist, performed in concerts at Victoria Hall, La Perle du Lac, [Le Relais de Chuit \(Genève Montagne\)](#), [L’Usine, Fête de la Musique \(Geneva\)](#), [Vandœuvres](#), Vernier, Switzerland
- Associated with the University of Geneva Choir for 4 consecutive years
- Former playback singer at Innokrea Motion Pictures ([Movie: Dhupkathi](#))
- Former All Bengal Radio Artist at Gyan-Vani F.M. (IGNOU)